



THESE WOMEN ARE IN THEIR OUTDOOR CLOTHES. EACH WOMAN HAS A SHAWL DRAPED OVER HER STOLA.

head to toe. It was so big that a man usually needed someone to help him drape it around his body in the correct way. Like the tunic, the *toga* could be decorated with bands of color. It was mainly worn on formal occasions, particularly by officials. Workers and slaves wore simpler clothes.

### Slip into a *stola*

The *stola* was the standard item of outer clothing for women. It was a long gown worn with a chest belt that caused it to hang down in folds. Some gowns had

sleeves, some didn't—it was a matter of taste. Over her *stola* (especially if she was outside), a woman wore a *palla*, which was a long shawl. She might also wear a scarf, tied at her neck.

### Father of the family

In Roman society, a "family" meant much more than a mother, a father, and their children. It also included the wives of the family's sons and their children, too. For much of Roman history, the oldest living male—the *paterfamilias*—was the head of the family. It was his duty to provide for the family and educate the children.

When a child was born into a Roman family, the father had a choice to make—whether to recognize it as his or not. If he took the baby in his arms, it was the sign of welcome into his family. If he did not pick the child up, it showed that he

### WEIRD WORLD

THE ROMAN WRITER PLINY THE ELDER (23–79 CE) RECOMMENDED THAT SPIDERS' WEBS BE APPLIED TO CUTS FROM SHAVING TO STOP THE BLEEDING!